

Interviewer: Okay, I think we're all set. I guess. Good day. Hi, [Participant's Name]. Okay, so let's get this started with your age, how old are you, [Participant's Name]?

Speaker: I'm currently, just got [20-25].

Interviewer: [20-25]?

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Belated happy birthday.

Speaker: Thank you.

Interviewer: Okay, so how long have you been with [Partner's Name], your partner?

Speaker: Last [Year] [Month]. And we got officially, or our status, we became last [Year] [Month]. So technically almost [1-5] years. [1-5] years and a few months.

Interviewer: Okay, so would you mind repeating that because I think you got a bit unstable.

Speaker: So [Partner's Name] and I met last [Month Year] and then we got officially a relationship last [Month Year].

Interviewer: Okay, I got that. So like [1-5] years and a few months.

Speaker: Yeah, roughly around that.

Interviewer: So do you already have children?

Speaker: No, currently studying.

Interviewer: Okay. Who lives in the household or what's your current household setup?

Speaker: So, I go to [Partner's Name], stay there for a few days and sometimes I stay here in my home.

Interviewer: Okay, so you live alone?

Speaker: He lives alone, yeah, he's in [Cty A] and his family is in [City B]. Well, my family is like, they live here in [City]. I live in the city.

Interviewer: Okay, I see. So what's your main source of income if you have any?

Speaker: As of now, allowances from my father.

Interviewer: So what year are you in college?

Speaker: [1st-4th year]. Irregular student.

Interviewer: Okay, I see.

Speaker: I just shifted from [degree program].

Interviewer: Okay, so your current program?

Speaker: [Degree Program].

Interviewer: [Degree Program], wow. We're the same. Okay, so how would you like us to address your partner throughout the interview? Would you like to call him [Partner's Name] or boyfriend, lover?

Speaker: [Partner's Name] is okay.

Interviewer: Okay, that's good. So, to start, can you tell us about, or can you tell me about your love story?

Speaker: Okay. So what happened for was, for instance, [Partner's Name], he messaged me before because I was heartbroken with someone, with my long-term boyfriend. And he punched me in the face because I posted some pictures and he commented on my pictures. And then one time, my friends planned, because one of my friends had a birthday. And then, all of them had a partner. And since I was broken, I didn't want to be alone. I just wanted to be with them. What I did was, I messaged a lot of guys, asking them to, if they want to come with me. Ang dami kong minessage. I asked them if they want to come with me. That's what happened. Prior to that, we had conversations with [Partner's Name]. And then, he messaged me first, siya yung unang nagmessage sa akin, na gusto niyang sumama. Then, sinabi kong sige, doon na nagstart, araw-araw na kaming magkausap, pumupunta na siya rito sa bahay. Then, ayon. He always went to the house for a year.

Interviewer: Yeah, it's about pandemic time, right? [Year].

Speaker: Yeah, it's about pandemic time. So, 'yung time na 'yun, 'yung mga alis alis namin, parang, panakaw pa 'yun o bawal.

Interviewer: So, what happened to the beach trip with your friends?

Well, it went good. 'Di ko inexpect na magiging okay kasama. 'Di ko inexpect na magclick kami. We just saw each other for a moment. We clicked. We were very opposite to each other at that time. He was so shy, tahimik siya, tapos ako, napakataalkative ko. Tapos lagi ko siyang ginugulo. Na-attach siya n'ung first day. He said, you don't have to go back to what I did. I just do this because I want to. Because he was very sweet on the first day. That's what happened to us.

Interviewer: And then, you went into dating. Did you date after? Before you officially together?

Speaker: We dated before for [1-5] years. Because I told him that I don't want to have a relationship. Because I just came out of a heartbreak. So, I don't think I'm ready for another serious thing. He said, wait for him. And then, gan'un yung setup namin for a year. Pupunta siya rito, matutulog,.

Interviewer: Thank you. And then after, what happened?

Speaker: That's it. What happened was, last [Month Day], we went to [Event Name]. It was good. And then, I got overly emotional about the things that I went through. So, when we went home, then naging kami na n'ung [Month Day].

Interviewer: So, doon pala ang time na sinagot mo na siya.

Speaker: Yes. Because of [Event Name].

Interviewer: That's cute. Okay. So, now, going strong.

Speaker: So, roughly around, [1-5 year] in [Month]. [1-5 years], officially.

Interviewer: Okay. That's cute. That's a cute love story. Now, how would you compare? So, let's talk about relationship quality. How would you compare your, the quality of your relationship with [Partner's Name] compared to that of your friends' relationship?

Speaker: Friends?

Interviewer: So, your relationship with your friends, how would you compare it to your relationship with [Partner's Name]?

Speaker: During our relationship with [Partner's Name], it's very calm. It's very, hindi siya katulad ng iba na very rough. A lot has happened to us. It's just calm. Magugulat na lang kami, isang buwan na pala kaming magkasama. Hindi siya grand. Hindi rin siya sobrang painful. [Partner's Name] is very gentle, very calm. So, I find it hard to adjust kasi hindi ko alam kung totoo yung pinapakita niya. Sa mga friends ko naman, nagtataka sila kung paano ko name-maintain yung relationship? Wala, yung relationship lang namin is parang mag-best friend. He's more into introvert side because most of the time, we're always on their house, nanood lang. Nagtataka sila, hindi kami masyadong nagpopost, gusto namin na maging sa'min lang yung relationship. Because the more people we have, ang daming nangingialam.

Interviewer: So very gentle, very calm. You also mentioned that you had an ex before.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: How many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker: [6-10].

Interviewer: [6-10]. Okay. So you also mentioned that you had an ex before.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Okay. So do you also mind if I ask about your gender or your sexual orientation?

Speaker: Yes. I'm gay and... ayun, gay lang.

Interviewer: Okay. So your previous relationship were they also...

Speaker: All guys. All gays.

Interviewer: All guys. Okay. Okay. So how would you compare? So kanina kasi, friends' relationship, right? How would you compare your relationship to those of your previous... your previous relationship? Your quality of relationship with...

Speaker: Quality of relationship. When it comes to gay relationship, because it's hard to find someone who will be with you. Because in the gay community, everything is a fast-paced. Then it's easy to change your partner. Because there are a lot of available guys that are lucky. So when one person sticks with you, it's very rare. So the past, the previous relationship, it's easy to end. It's like three months. But otherwise, there was this one guy, we've been together for almost [1-5 years]. But ang nangyari kasi sa amin, it's like a very toxic relationship. Then he cheated a few times. Then ayoko na, pero hindi niya ako nilelet go. Then, tinatakot niya ako na magpapakamatay siya kapag iniwan ko siya. So, yung pandemic yung escape ko sa kanya. Kasi hindi kami pwedeng magkita. Ayun yung naging opportunity ko to let him

go. Tapos yung mga relationship ko in the past, very rough. Si [Partner's Name] yung pinakagentle kong tao na nakilala.

Interviewer: Okay. Just to clarify, this guy that I've been with for [1-5 years]. Is he the one before [Partner's Name]?

Speaker: Yes, before [Partner's Name].

Interviewer: Okay. I see.

Speaker: Kaya hindi ako sanay sa ugali. Nagdodoubt ako sa ugali ni [Partner's Name] kasi nasanay ako sa almost [1-5 years] ko.

Interviewer: They're coming from that experience then, right?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Okay. So with that, you mentioned the quality of... You compare the quality of relationship. So for you, what makes a relationship high quality?

Speaker: I think, I know. I don't think the satisfaction or the high quality of a relationship doesn't measure with the status or the things that you do. What matters the most is how you see that person, how you see their relationship overall. Because for me, I am satisfied in a way that I don't need to look for someone else. I don't know what [Partner's Name] is giving me. I can't get him on the same page. If I leave him or break up with him, I can't look for someone like him. So in the ocean, I'm looking for a rare fish. I don't want to let that go. I'm very satisfied with what I got from him. It's not a high maintenance. It's a low maintenance of our relationship. For all the people that I know, [Partner's Name] is very good at taking care of us. Even if we don't understand each other, we have our own lapses as a person. I still understand him.

Interviewer: How about low quality? What makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker: Low quality when... It's hard to be in a relationship. Everything that happens to you is not uncomfortable. That's what I feel about my ex. High quality and low quality, but more on low quality. Even if he gives me a lot of love, it's not enough. Love is not enough in a relationship. You need to have respect. You need to compromise with each other. Yung nangyayari sa amin, it's more on love bombing. He will do what I want to receive. Then he will do something wrong. Wala rin yung ginagawa niya. Parehas kaming nasasaktan, kahit na gusto namin mag-let go, hidni namin kaya mag-let go sa isa't isa. Low quality. Why do we need to stay in a relationship? If both of you are hurt.

Interviewer: That's a clear description of low quality for you. Just to clarify, you say that a relationship is of high quality when you are satisfied in the relationship. If low maintenance lang din siya. As for low quality, it's hard to be breathe in a relationship. More of love bombing. With that, can you say that your relationship with [Partner's Name] is of high quality?

Speaker: At some point, yes. I can still do my thing. That he doesn't care. For me, a relationship shouldn't be considered a relationship to be yourself. What happens is, I join him in trying different things, making myself better. It's like I'm in a company with other people. He's not overpowering my relationship with other people. I'm also clear about that. You can't make me not go with my friends if they need me. I'm a yes partner, but you're just one of the people that I need to take care of. I

understand that. At first, it was hard. In the long run, I got the point that there are other people, not just them. That's how our relationship became a flow. We're always together, but we don't take care of each other. That's what they want to do. I think that's good to hear.

Interviewer: You also mentioned that love is not the only thing enough in a relationship. For you, what are the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker: I think it's respect. It's easy to get love. Even in a day, you can love someone. Respect for someone. Sometimes, it goes against our principle, our views. For me, in a relationship, respect is the most difficult thing to achieve. Even if you love someone, when you don't have respect, it will work. Because what will happen is that it will hurt you.

Interviewer: Thank you. With that, love, aside from love, isn't the only thing, mas important pa rin yung respect sa relationship. But going back to love, for you, what is love?

Speaker: Love. It's difficult. Love for me is when you get to be yourself. Alongside with a person who understands you, who supports you, who cherishes you, who nourishes you. And you also do the same to that person. Love is all about growing. Growing to a better person. And sharing it with other people too. Love heals you. Love can also be a way for you to be a better human. Love is easy to see. It's easy to get. But not all love is genuine. So you have to be very careful with sharing love and also receiving love. It's all about doing the things that you... Sharing your vulnerable side with other people. Because they say, you can hurt people you love. Love is when you fully accept and show your vulnerable side to the selective of people.

Interviewer: Okay. So you mentioned love is the only thing enough in the relationship. But how important do you think is love in the relationship?

Speaker: It is important. Love is always intertwined with care. So if you love a person, you will take care of them. Kasi yung iba, magkasama sila, pero wala nang love. So doon papasok yung pananakit, yung gagawa ka ng mga bagay na hindi mo, na makakasakit sa partner mo. So, with love. It's always connected with care. If you don't have love, walang mangyayari sa relationship niyo. That's why love is important.

Interviewer: And how do you know when a partner, when your partner loves you? So in your case with [Partner's Name], how did you know? Or how do you know that [Partner's Name] loves you?

Speaker: I don't believe with the word I love you. Because it's very easy to say. I look more into their actions. With [Partner's Name], napatunayan kong love niya ako. Kasi minsan, may ugali ako na, minsan hindi siya Maganda. Pero naaddress ko siya, aware rin siya, tapos natotolerate rin niya. Tapos, napapansin niya yung mga small things sa akin na hindi ko napapansin. Tapos sinasabi niya 'yun sa akin. Inaaddress niya. Negatively and positively. And then, yung love language niya, very service. Nakikita kong maasikaso siya, kapag pumupunta ako sa kanila, sobrang maasikaso siya. Tapos, hindi kami sweet sa public pero I know na kapag tinitingnan niya ako, merong affection.

Interviewer: Okay. That's cute. That's cute to hear. And going back to what you mentioned, love is about growing. And then sharing it to other first ones. So with that, would you say that the relationship is good for you?

Speaker: Yes. Because we both change each other. Because I've learned a lot from him. And he's the same. I think for me. It's based on my perspective. That we change each other for the betterment. There. So I think there are things that I do. Views. I take care of others. It became a way to change what I believed before. Then... But in our relationship, I feel like I'm more dominant. Because sometimes, as a site, I feel like I'm hurting. I feel like I'm wrong. I shouldn't be like that. I unconsciously do that. Then he said to me, you need to let him think about what I want to think. Even if he's against your beliefs. So there. It's a bit difficult for me in that part.

Interviewer: I see that's understandable. And speaking of changes, did the relationship you mentioned about changes, which is to bring back the question, did the relationship change you? And in what way, aside from what you mentioned about your beliefs and perspective?

Speaker: Maybe the quality of life. Because before [Partner's Name], I was very strict with my parents. I had a lot of things to do. I had a lot of things to do. I could go out with friends. Because my ex-partner got mad at me. Now, with [Partner's Name], the whole relationship is so free. It's so liberated in a way that I get to bond with my other friends. And even though he's not with one of my parents, or he doesn't like a lot of people, he joins me. He joins me. When he connects with my friends, for me, the relationship is beautiful. Because all the important people I know, and I want to know them. For me, he's very important to me. He also knows why they're important to me. Then, he values my values, regards to connection. Because I'm a highly advocate of connection. Since I have friends who made me realize that I need to value the relationship with them, even if it's platonic or romantic.

Interviewer: Thank you. That's good to hear. How about the other way around? Did the relationship change [Partner's Name]?

Speaker: I can't tell. Because he's not open as a person. There are times when he becomes vulnerable. Pero 'yung aamin siya, hindi kasi siya umaamin. We're both competitive. We're both competitive. Sometimes, I see him being shy when showing off his vulnerable side. But based on my observation, at some point, yes. There are beliefs and actions that [Partner's Name] before, an for me, nakaka-off siya. Then, I warned him kung bakit siya mali o bakit siya pangit sa paningin ko. Tapos ngayon, ginagawa niya na unconsciously. Nagbibigay siya ng atensyon sa sinasabi ko.

Interviewer: Okay. So, that's really good in the relationship being open. And it also shows that even if you don't notice, there's really change within the relationship. So, let's talk about challenges in the relationship. What would you say are challenges in your relationship?

Speaker: As I said from earlier, our relationship is very calm. So, the things that would be small things. Mag-aaway kami based sa ugali niya, ayon. Ayun yung mostly namin pinag-aawayan, kasi pareho kaming strong yung personality. Nagc-clash yung ugali namin. But other than that, there's no problem with third-party, there's no problem with financial. Mostly, in our personality, Personality, hindi siya nagmamatch. Personality is the difficulty in our relationship.

Interviewer: Okay. I see. Do you and your partner fight? Do you and [Partner's Name] fight?

Speaker: Yes. We fight. Our way of fighting, is when he's angry, tatahimik na siya tapos tatalikuran niya ako. Tapos ako, ang way ng galit ko, magiging pilosopo na ako, magiging madaldal na ako, to the point na kapag sasabihin kong aalis na ako, sasabihin niya, sige. Sasabihin ko, hindi mo man lang ako pipigilan,

gano'n, tapos sasabihin niya, hindi. Pero ayaw niyang iwan ko siya at umalis, pero indi naman namin siya macommunicate kasi yung ugali namin, competitive.

Interviewer: Thank you. So how often would you say you fight like this? How often would you say it happened?

Speaker: It's not often. Kasi parang yung iba, nagiging biruan na lang din namin. Yung way namin ng lambingan, mag-aaway kami. Pero hindi siya yung offensive eh. Ayaw na funny, kasi ginagaya namin yung nuances ng bawat isa. Tapos ayun yung nangyayari. Hindi siya madalas. Siguro paminsan-minsan, kapag sobra na.

Interviewer: So more on, hindi naman siya gan'on ka-offensive, light lang.

Speaker: Sa [1-5 years] namin siguro, mabibilang lang sa kamay yung mga talagang away, malalang away.

Interviewer: So, do you mind if I ask kung tungkol saan yung malalaking away niyo before?

Speaker: Pinakanakatawang away namin, yung sinabi ko sa kanya na ayaw ko na siyang kalaro sa [Game Name]. Tapos, nagtampo siya. Tapos doon na, nag-away na kami. Sabi ko, aalis na ako, tapos sabi niya, edi umalis ka. Tapos nag-impake ako ng things ko, tapos sabi ko last time, aalis na ako. Sabi niya, umalis ka na. Tapos sabi ko, magbreak na tayo, sabi niya, sige magbreak na tayo, ayun na, ilang days kaming hidni nag-usap. Tapos ang ugali niya kasi, ib-block niya ako sa lahat. Gan'un siya. Gusto niyang iblock yung nagpapastress sa kanya. Tapos ang ginagawa ko, minemessage ko siya sa gmail, sesendan ko siya ng gcash, tapos may message roon. Ayun, ang petty, pero ang laking away, pero ang petty ng reason.

Interviewer: So you play [Game Name] pala, you play together.

Speaker: Yes. I influenced him because on the first day we met, Nakita niya na naglalaro kami. He was interested. Tapos ayun, nagtuloy-tuloy na. Ayun din yung source ng away namin, yung [Game Name].

Interviewer: Bakit, in what way?

Speaker: Kasi nababadtrip kami sa isa't isa kapag naglalaro. Kapag may hindi siya ginawa na gusto kong gawin tapos same rin siya sa akin, dun na kami nagsisimula mag-away.

Interviewer: So, mga in game na away.

Speaker: Oo. Tapos hindi kami magpapansinan for a few hours. Tapos sasabihin ko, gutom na ako, tapos kakain na kami, tapos doon na magbabati.

Interviewer: Okay, that's funny.

Speaker: He's not a problematic person. He's not problematic. He's a very logical thinker. Pero doon Babali kasi yung views niya eh, sa [Game Name]. Doon nasisira yung mga beliefs niya na maging composed siyang tao. Kapag naglalaro siya ng [Game Name], nawawala yung pagiging composed niya.

Interviewer: Yah, pag natilt na sa in-game.

Speaker: Oo.

Interviewer: O kahit picking pa lang—

Speaker: Oo, picking pa lang, nag-aaway na kami.

Interviewer: Going back to, how do you resolve this fight? So, hindi kayo magpapansinan. So, more like, cool down or cool down first. But, aside from that, how do you resolve other fights? Maybe the other petty ones.

Speaker: Ano, parang nagsosorry ako. Tapos, gusto niya lang kasing marinig sa akin, sorry ganyan, tapos kung ano yung ginawa ko. So minsan, may mga times na hindi ako aware, sa mga actions ko, so hindi ko siya na-address sa kanya. Dun siya nagagalit. Kasi hindi ko napapansin yung ugali ko. Tapos nagsosorry ako. Tapos ilang araw lang, ilang hours lang, magbabati na kami. For us, he was the most understanding for me.

Interviewer: I see. I hope you don't bother. I'll just do something real quick. Wait a minute. Hi. Hello. Sorry. Kasi naiwan yung pusa dito sa loob ng kwarto. Di siya makalabas. So, you mentioned that you resolved the fight by apologizing. Communicating din, no. And, just to clarify, how long do these fights last? So, how long is the duration before you resolve?

Interviewer: Because, as for [Game Name], [Game Name] related, for a few hours. For a few hours.

Speaker: The other problems, the longest is one week. One week. One week, mostly, three days, four days. Nagpapacool down lang. Because, he'll think about the problem for a day. Then, he'll talk to me.

Interviewer: I see.

Speaker: Ako kasi, 'yung opposite.

Interviewer: Logical talaga. Logical. Even when it comes to conflicts and problems. So, aside from that, aside from cool down, communication, what other ways are you doing within the relationship? What are the things you do to maintain the relationship?

Speaker: We try different things. As a person, I love traveling. I love crowded places. I love to connect with people. Parang siya, nakikisabay siya sa akin. So, now, he loves traveling, trying different things. I guess, experiences with life maintains our relationship. The more you experience different things, it's like we become satisfied with what we have.

Interviewer: That's good. More experiences maintain the relationship. The relationship. Okay. How about safety? Do you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker: Yes, I can say it. We're very open to each other. We're like best friends. As for the people who trust him, when he trusts you, don't break it. For those trusted people, he shows his vulnerable side. Nakita ko na yung vulnerable side niya. Then, knowing his whole personality and his whole being, I feel safe in him.

Interviewer: So, with [Partner's Name] towards you, he's more open because he shows his vulnerable side.

Speaker: Hindi, mas open ako. Open pa rin siya, pero may boundaries. Ako kasi, minsan nagiging open book ako, madaldal gan'on, tapos yung mga emotions ko, madali ko siyang mapakita, nababasa niya ako.

Interviewer: So, ikaw, ikaw towards him, you're very open. You can freely show your vulnerable side.

Interviewer: Okay, I see. Let's proceed to the next part. I'll be showing you something. Let me just share my screen real quick. Okay. Can you see my screen?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: So, let's start with this first statement together. On a scale of one, with one as not at all true and nine as completely true, how would you rate this statement in your relationship with [Partner's Name]? My partner usually really listens to me.

Speaker: Number seven, very true.

Interviewer: Okay. How about this second statement? My partner usually is responsive to my needs. Same scale.

Speaker: Eight. Number eight. Eight.

Interviewer: Okay. I'll just stop sharing for a while. Okay. Okay. You mentioned that for the first statement about listening, why seven?

Speaker: Why seven? Because sometimes I don't listen especially against his beliefs. There are times when I like to say that he doesn't acknowledge or something. But he listens to me. But he doesn't show me what I'm saying.

Interviewer: I see. So you answered seven. Why not six? Or why not nine?

Speaker: Eight. Six or eight? I think seven is the best for three. The overall that [Partner's Name] does. He listens to me not entirely.

Interviewer: Okay. Not at all times.

Speaker: Not at all times. But most of the time, not at all times.

Interviewer: How about the second statement? You answered eight for the statement. My partner is usually responsive to my needs.

Speaker: Sometimes there are lapses na hindi niya, parang kailangan mo pang sabihin na, in the span of [1-5 years], may mga bagay na kailangan alam mo na agad pero parang when it comes to him, minsan kailangan ko pang i-communicate, pero okay lang naman. Pero wala lang, based lang sa expectations ko.

Interviewer: But can you give a more concrete example about this in terms of his responsiveness to your needs?

Speaker: Siguro sa ano ko lang 'yan, as a petty personality, kailangan kapag ginawa ko 'to, ganito na yung response mo. Because sometimes when I go to their place, I will stay for a few days. Ang dami kong bitbit. Tapos ang bigat niya. Tapos hidni niya man lang ako susunduin, hindi niya man lang ako sasalubungin. Hindi mo ako susunduin, alam mong marami akong dala? Kailangan ko pa siyang sabihin sa kanya. Parang hidni siya, wala siyang initial response na, okay, ako na gagawa nito.

Interviewer: I see. Just to clarify. As for listening, he listens but not at all times. But most of the time he is like that. As for being responsive to your needs, sometimes there are lapses that you need to say. So

moving forward I hope you don't mind if I ask. But also we want to know about your physical intimacy as a couple. So these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker: Not often. Because I am active with sex but [Partner's Name] is more of a side because he is not like that often. Once in a while maybe 3 times or 4 times very often. Maybe before one year maybe often. Now it's like one month. Just for me I don't want to I don't know how he feels. It's not his but the idea is what he wants.

Interviewer: How satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker: [redacted]. Because in my gay community it's very rampant, sex. You can sex with different people but you can't receive the same you want to receive. That's the case with [Partner's Name]. The quality of love he gives to me. I'm more after the relationship compared to sex or physical intimacy.

Interviewer: I see. Thank you for sharing that. Actually we're nearing the end of our interview but I'll show another slide. Just share my screen real quick. Okay. Can you see my screen?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: With all this in mind how satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker: Completely satisfied. ompletely satisfied.

Interviewer: Okay. That's good to hear. You mentioned you're completely satisfied. Just to follow up scale again and share it. How would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship? On a scale of 0 to 10.

Speaker: Oh 9. Maybe we still have to work. We have to fix our lapses but satisfied very satisfied. Completely satisfied.

Interviewer: Okay. Why not 10 or 8?

Speaker: Maybe because we need to work on our relationship. Maybe 8 because for me the quality of our relationship is not the quality of our relationship. But it's not too high. It's like we're at 9.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: We'll work on the relationship that will be 10.

Interviewer: I see. So 9 is the perfect for now. Okay.

Interviewer: So we are close to wrapping this up and I would just like to summarize what we have discussed about for the last minutes ago. So I'll just summarize each point or each question and then feel free to correct me in the middle. I'll start with your demographics. You mentioned that you're [20-25] years old and then as for the duration with your partner so roughly around [1-5 years] but officially together it's [1-5 years] and around almost [1-5 years] and a few months. Okay. So have no children and then as for your household living conditions, he lives alone he rents and lives alone and then you're living with your family and then you're still studying. You're currently in [1st-4th year] college and then as for your love story even before and then your friends plan for a beach trip and then since you're broken and most of your friends brought their partners they messaged you and then he agreed to join you on that beach trip and then you dated for quite a while and you didn't expect at first you'll click as in

the relationship and then you dated for a year and during one of [Event Name] [Month Year] so you got overly emotional with things you went through and you decided to say yes and officially you became in a relationship.

Interviewer: And then as for relationship quality compared with most of your friends it's very calm it's very gentle which you had some difficulties adjusting because the previous relationship wasn't that good and then you also had [6-10] relationships in the past and [Partner's Name] is the [6th-10th] one and you also mentioned that in the gay community, it's somehow common to change or to find a new partner and the relationship was a bit difficult but there was one in your previous relationship, almost [1-5 years] but it was a bit toxic and it was also difficult for you to let go of each other but as for comparing it with your previous relationship and then as for high quality you mentioned that it's not about the status but it's about how you see the person and the overall relationship and it's more on satisfaction so it's like rare fish as you describe and it's a low maintenance relationship and then as for low-quality relationship if you're having difficulties and if there are situations of love bombing .

Interviewer: And then you also mentioned that your relationship with [Partner's Name] is of high quality because you can still do your thing and the relationship does not hinder you to be yourself and it doesn't overpower your relationships with other people. And although love is not the only one enough in the relationship respect is the most important thing for you because love is easy to give and receive but respect it's very difficult especially with principles, different principles and beliefs. And then as for your conceptualization of love it's when you get to be yourself and when you become a better human because it's very easy to give and receive love but the genuine love is somehow difficult to find. And then you also mentioned that love is intertwined with care loving a person means you're caring for them and you don't believe in I love you because you're more into action or what they show and you believe that [Partner's Name] loves you because he shows it through love languages and the relationship itself has values that are not tolerated and you're saying that and then as for challenges in the relationship more on small things because you have a strong personality and competitive and of course the [Game Name] fights although it's not that frequent and it's more on more on petty things and then you resolve it by apologizing and communicating and as for the duration it doesn't last more than a week it's the longest one week and then roughly around 3 days and 4 days and then aside from that you also look into experience and for you experience it's one thing that maintains your relationship.

Interviewer: So you also mentioned the relationship is good for you because it both changes you in a positive way. You have new views and perspectives in life and the quality of life also changed for now with your relationship with [Partner's Name] it's free flowing and it's not restricted and free and liberated as you described and you also value that [Partner's Name] gives importance to the relationships you have with your friends you really don't know and that's when you know that you value the relationship and you value the relationship you have with these other people and then you also feel safe because you're very open with the relationship you show your vulnerable side and on the other way around feeding he's open but with boundaries. And then as for the scale the first part of scale you rated 7 for the statements about listening of what I was listening because he listens but not at all times and as for when it comes to your when it comes to his responsiveness to your needs and as for your physical intimacy it's not that common and it's not that common in your relationship but it doesn't matter because you're more after the relationship the value of the relationship compared to the sex and the physical intimacy you experience and in general you're completely satisfied with the relationship

and you rated it as a 9 because you work out in the relationship but your quality of relationship okay so was that right did I capture everything or would you like to add some more?

Speaker: The only thing I'd like to add is the previous relationship is not and, it's a toxic one.

Interviewer: Okay okay wait okay so it's a very toxic relationship okay. Are there other things you want to correct or add back? Okay okay so was that thank you so much.

Interviewer: Now before we end I would like to talk to you about how we will handle the data for this research project because of course we want to be as ethically transparent as possible and I wanted you to know about the data sharing option that and feel free to choose which are your most comfortable with. So there are two data sharing options so I'll be discussing it so option one is transcribed portions can be shared none of which can be identified to you so the de-identified transcript can also be read by other researchers that's option one. And then as for option two if you're a bit bolder you can have the whole transcript shared remove the sensitive and overly identifying details so that it will be anonymized although in this option there's a very minimal chance that someone who knows you can piece well the details although it would take time because they would have to review all the appendices and references of the research material but although again no sensitive information will be shared so again option one transcribed portions are shared and then option two the whole transcript will be shared. So of these two options which are you most comfortable with?

Speaker: Two.

Interviewer: Okay. Again thank you so much for participating in this study it's really a valuable valuable interview it's a productive interview and I would also like you to know that this study is actually being done then in the Philippines, Brazil, Turkey France and the US. So for this study it's a multi-country study. So for this study to be successful there's also one last thing we'll ask of you so can you recommend two close people in your life as a nominator? So what will happen is they're nominators because you'll provide two names with their contact details and then they'll we'll be asking them for additional couples that can be interviewed similar to you [Partner's Name] so they'll ask us for couples that who might be interested in being interviewed so in that way because the network is more diverse the network is more diverse the reach of our respondents. So would that be okay?

Speaker: Yes yes yes.

Interviewer: So as for that [Partner's Name] also mentioned because he's interviewed he mentioned he doesn't have many friends so I think you'll discuss how to go about it so yes but roughly we'll be needing in that case we'll be needing four nominators because two each—

Speaker: Was that for you? Do you need two for him or four for me?

Interviewer: Two for him and two for you so you also need to get one but he said you're the one with more friends so I think you'll discuss about it and how to go about it but yes we'll be needing two from him and two from you so feel free to send it anytime it's not as urgent as possible and then if possible is contact their email email and phone number and then if possible heads up in case so they won't block us or something when we contact them okay so let me just stop the recording real quick thank you again.

Speaker: Thank you miss.

